the efforts of the Israeli intelligence community, the allocation of financial resources, the allocation of human resources, and the development of capabilities in the areas of weapons and technology. This prioritization, which was decided upon by MI in its role as the "national assessor," was met with skepticism in the Mossad, especially in view of the growing Iraqi threat, which had not been degraded despite the Iran-Iraq War. The Mossad's doubts were connected to the fact that it was the Mossad that had led the intelligence gathering on and thwarting of Iraq's buildup of strategic capabilities. A dispute therefore arose between MI and the Mossad regarding the order of priorities vis-à-vis the threats facing Israel. In 1987, for example, Military Intelligence placed Syria in first place on the EEI and Iraq only third, whereas the Mossad placed the Iraqi threat, with regard to everything related to intelligence collection and prevention efforts, in first place.

In analyzing the historical background to the incongruence of the threat assessments of MI and the Mossad at that time, we must return to the Yom Kippur War. This was the first war since the establishment of the State of Israel that concluded with the establishment of a state commission of inquiry that investigated the issue of intelligence alerts and other aspects of the war related to intelligence. In other words—you have to pay for your mistakes, and the head of Military Intelligence, Major General Eli Zeira, indeed paid for his failure and was removed from his post. His dismissal, as well as that of IDF chief of staff Lieutenant General David Elazar, was a traumatic event for the IDF and the state. My subjective opinion, based on my long working relationship with Military Intelligence, is that this trauma had a psychological effect on the MI heads who served in the post after 1973 and that the decisions of the Agranat Commission became a kind of sword hanging over their heads. More than once I got the feeling that one MI head or another was operating as if he was there against his will and was counting down the days until the end of his term. This mental state may have influenced the fact that the subject of the early warnings of war with Syria occupied the highest place on the EEI year after year, with excessive resources being allocated to it. In retrospect, the Iraqi threat, which intensified in the second half of the 1970s and the 1980s, deserved a higher priority than it actually received, even though Iraq is in Israel's "outer circle," and despite the Iran-Iraq War. The thirty-nine Scud missiles launched from Iraq against Israel with the outbreak of the First Gulf War